

SMART AMRITA HACKATHON 2026 | PROJECT EXPO*Guidelines for Students*

The Project Expo is a demonstration-based component of Smart Amrita Hackathon (SAH) 2026. It invites students to exhibit **existing and ongoing projects** before an expert jury of faculty, researchers and industry professionals. Unlike the hackathon track, it does not require a new build — it recognises work already developed and creates a pathway to awards, IP support, industry connect and startup incubation.

1. Objectives

- Showcase outstanding student projects, prototypes and technological solutions across departments.
- Encourage engineering innovation, problem-solving and interdisciplinary collaboration.
- Enable structured evaluation by faculty, researchers and external industry experts.
- Identify projects with potential for patenting, commercialisation, industry deployment or startup development.

2. Eligibility — Who Can Apply?

Criterion	Requirement
Who may apply	Students of any B.Tech, M.Tech or PhD programme, in any year of study.
Team size	2–3 students per project. Interdisciplinary teams across departments are strongly encouraged.
Faculty mentor	Mandatory. A faculty mentor from any department must endorse the project, certifying student authorship and demonstration readiness.
Project stage	Ongoing or completed, and sufficiently developed for a live demonstration before the jury.
Entries per student	A student may be part of not more than two Project Expo teams.
Projects accepted	Final-year, capstone and mini-projects with significant innovation; course-based projects with substantial engineering implementation; interdisciplinary projects; and independently developed student prototypes.

3. Project Scope

Qualifying output. A project qualifies if it demonstrates at least one of the following: *a functional hardware prototype or device; a working software application or platform; an integrated hardware–software system; a robotics or automation system; an AI/ML implementation with demonstrable output; an IoT or cyber-physical system; a validated experimental setup with measurable results; or a simulation or engineering design with verified performance.*

Domains (*indicative, not restrictive*). *AI & Machine Learning · Data Science & Computing · Electronics & Embedded Systems · IoT & Cyber-Physical Systems · Communication & Signal Processing · VLSI & Semiconductor Technologies · Robotics & Automation · Healthcare & Biomedical Technology · Energy & Sustainable Technologies · Advanced Materials & Nanotechnology · Smart Manufacturing · Smart Campus Solutions · Environmental & Social Innovation · Interdisciplinary Technologies · Open Innovation.*

Essential condition. The project must have sufficient technical maturity for a meaningful live demonstration and technical discussion with the jury. Concept posters, literature surveys and video-only submissions without a functioning system will **not** be accepted.

4. Selection Process and Key Dates

The Project Expo will be held on **Thursday, 10 September 2026**. All deadlines close at 5.00 p.m. on the date indicated. No extensions will be granted.

#	Stage	Description	Date
1	Call for Projects & Registration Opens	Event coordinators invite students to nominate existing and ongoing projects. Online registration opens.	Mon, 24 Aug 2026
2	Registration Closes	Last date for entries, with project title, team and mentor details. Late entries will not be considered.	Mon, 31 Aug 2026
3	Documentation Submission	Shortlisted teams shall submit the Project Information Sheet and supporting technical documents as per the stipulated template.	Sat, 5 Sep 2026
4	Screening & Shortlisting	Screening committees review all entries for relevance, technical merit, innovation, completeness and demonstration potential.	Sun–Mon, 6–7 Sep 2026
5	Announcement of Shortlist	Selected teams are notified and Project IDs are allotted.	Mon, 7 Sep 2026
6	Project Expo & Jury Evaluation	Selected projects are exhibited and demonstrated live before visitors and the expert jury, and evaluated using the rubric in Section 5.	Thu, 10 Sep 2026
7	Awards & Opportunity Mapping	Winners announced. Projects with strong potential are referred for IP/patent support, industry connect, incubation or the SAH Startup Pitch.	Thu, 10 Sep 2026

5. Evaluation Rubric

Each project is evaluated out of 50 marks during the live demonstration and technical interaction.

Criterion	Marks	What the Jury Looks For
Problem Definition & Objectives	5	Clarity and relevance of the problem; well-defined, measurable objectives; appropriate scope.
Design & Technical Approach	10	Soundness of methodology and architecture; justification of technology choices; depth of technical understanding.
Build Quality & Completeness	15	Quality of the prototype; degree of completion; integration, reliability and functional completeness.
Live Demonstration & Performance	10	Actual working of the system; testing, validation and measured performance; ability to explain results.
Application Value & Scalability	5	Real-world relevance and user benefit; industry or social application; scalability and deployment potential.
Presentation & Documentation	5	Clarity of communication; quality of documentation and display; response to jury questions.
Total	50	

Note: Every team member must be able to explain their individual contribution and clearly distinguish student-developed components from externally sourced hardware, software, libraries or datasets.

6. Award Categories and Recognition

Each category carries a **Winner** and a **Runner-Up**, determined by the expert jury on the basis of the rubric in Section 5 and the technical interaction at the stall.

#	Structure	Award Category	Basis
1	Excellence	Best Overall Project	Highest overall performance across all rubric criteria.

#	Structure	Award Category	Basis
2	Innovation & Engineering	Best Innovation	Most original and creative approach to a clearly identified problem.
3	Innovation & Engineering	Best Working Prototype	Fully functional, well-demonstrated system with strong performance and practical usability.
4	Innovation & Engineering	Best Technical Implementation	Depth in engineering design, fabrication or coding, integration, testing and optimisation.
5	Collaboration	Best Interdisciplinary Project	Effective integration of two or more disciplines into a stronger solution.
6	Industry & Enterprise	Best Industry-Relevant Project	Addresses a genuine industry problem with clear potential for adoption or deployment.
7	Industry & Enterprise	Best Startup Potential	Viable product or venture, assessed on market need, scalability and feasibility.
8	Impact	Best Social Impact Project	Addresses a societal, healthcare, accessibility, rural or community challenge.
9	Impact	Best Sustainable Technology	Contributes to environmental sustainability, clean energy, efficiency or resource conservation.
10	Emerging Talent	Young Innovator Award	Most promising project from a first- or second-year team.

Certificates and medals. Winner and Runner-Up team members will each receive a medal and a certificate. All participants will receive e-participation certificates.

Award eligibility. A project may receive one category award only, and the Best Overall Project winner is not eligible for any other category. If deserving projects are not found in a particular category, the award will not be conferred — this applies to both Winner and Runner-Up positions. The decision of the jury is final.

7. General Information

Exhibition display. Mandatory at the stall: project title and Project ID, team members, faculty mentor, department, the working prototype or system, a short description, key innovation, major results and applications. Recommended: system architecture diagram, key performance metrics, and a QR code linking to a demonstration video or repository.

Backup demonstration. Every team must carry a backup — demonstration video, screenshots, sample datasets or recorded results. This is a contingency for technical failure at the venue and does not substitute for a live demonstration.

Safety. Teams must ensure safe operation of all demonstrations. Projects involving high voltage or current, batteries, motors, lasers, chemicals, biological materials, pressurised systems, heat-generating equipment, rotating machinery or sharp components must be declared at registration and cleared by the Organising Committee, which may prohibit any demonstration considered unsafe.

Academic integrity. Projects must be original student work. Teams must acknowledge external resources, cite software, libraries and datasets used, declare AI-assisted development as required by institutional policy, and present no fabricated results. Misrepresentation of third-party work as student-developed will lead to disqualification.

Enquiries. All queries may be addressed to the SAH 2026 Project Expo Organising Committee.

8. Enquiries and Organising Committee

Students may approach the Programme Faculty Coordinator for their own programme in the first instance. Queries of a general nature may be sent to the Organising Committee by email.

#	Organising Committee Member	Programme / Role
1	Dr. S. Parthasarathy	Project Expo – Campus SPoC
2	Dr. Rishikumar	MECH & RAI Programme Faculty Coordinator
3	Dr. S. Veluchamy	ECE & CCE Programme Faculty Coordinator
4	Dr. K. Ashwini	CSE Program Faculty Coordinator
5	Dr. IR Oviya	AI & CYS Programme Faculty Coordinator

Channel	Details
Email	sah@ch.amrita.edu
Website — full details	[website address to be inserted] — problem statements, registration link, formats, FAQs and announcements.

QR CODE

Scan for everything about SAH 2026 – Project Expo
Or write to sah@ch.amrita.edu

placeholder — insert QR image

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